Beyond Data: AI for Human Connection

SYNC

Benchmark Yourself

Insights Across the StratusLIVE Community

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Speakers

Gary Carr

Chief Financial Officer

Danielle Reilly

Sr. Business Intelligence Analyst

Today's Topics

1. **The Big Picture**
   Industry trends & context
2. **Your Software Has Answers**
   StratusLIVE data by product
3. **Where Do We Go**
   Takeaways & next steps

1 The Big Picture

Industry trends, sources, and more

Data Overload Is Real

Nonprofits are swimming in benchmarks — but does it move your needle?

Data

Raw numbers with no context or direction

Metrics

Measures disconnected from strategy

KPIs

Benchmarks that don't fit your org

Reports

Insights nobody acts on

The real question: which data drives YOUR decisions and is specific to YOUR organization?

The U.S. Giving Landscape

Do these macro stats really help us in our jobs?

$592B	+3% Real	$85B	1.8M
Total U.S. Giving	Growth (inflation-adjusted)	Through DAFs & Rising	Nonprofits Nationwide

Where Giving Comes FROM

74%	Individuals (gifts + bequests)
19%	Foundations
7%	Corporations

Where Giving Goes TO

23%	Religion
14%	Human Services
14%	Education
11%	Public Benefit
10%	Health

Trends Nonprofits Must Navigate

Do these factors really help us in our jobs?

Headwinds

- Inflation & cost pressures
- Wage growth / stagnation
- Jobs market volatility
- Wealth concentration
- Gatekeepers of wealth: DAFs, Corporations, Foundations

Opportunities & Shifts

- Demographic shifts in donor base
- Preferences of younger donors
- News cycle & cause alignment
- Impact of technology on giving
- AI enabling personalization at scale

Key insight: Most of these forces are outside your control. Focus your KPIs on what you CAN move.

7 Nonprofit KPIs to Know

Industry benchmarks from the experts

KPI	2023	2024	2025	Trend
Total Funds Raised (YoY Growth)	+2–3%	+3–4%	**+4–5%**	↑ Growing
Donor Retention Rate	41%	42%	**43%**	→ Steady
Donor Acquisition Rate (New)	17–19%	18–20%	**19–21%**	↑ Improving
Cost to Raise $1	$0.27	$0.26	**$0.25**	→ Steady
Average Gift Size	$124	$130	**$135**	↑ Growing
Major Gift % of Revenue	58%	60%	**60–62%**	↑ Growing
Recurring Giving Rate	18%	19%	**20%**	→ Steady

KPIs — Better Put Simply

Are we growing?

Total revenue and donor counts trending in the right direction year over year.

Are we acquiring efficiently?

New donor cost and acquisition rate — growing your base sustainably without breaking the bank.

Are we retaining our growth?

Retention rate, multi-year giving, and churn — keeping what you earn is just as important as earning it.

My Advice

Balance industry-leading KPIs against your own business reality.

1

Your Organization's Uniqueness

Mission, constituency, geography, and history all shape what metrics matter most for YOUR org.

2

Your Strategic Objectives

A capital campaign year looks different from a stewardship year. Align KPIs to current goals.

3

Leadership Consensus

Metrics you can't get buy-in on won't drive change. Align leadership before you measure.

You can't measure everything — prioritize.

Where to Find Benchmark Data

- Giving USA
- Independent Sector
- Natl. Center for Charitable Statistics
- Bureau of Labor Statistics
- AFP Fundraising Effectiveness Project
- US Census Bureau
- National Philanthropic Trust (DAF)
- Candid
- **Nonprofit & Digital Fundraising Platform Reports**

Why does this matter?

Consistent sources = credible benchmarks you can confidently defend to leadership and your board.

Why Platform Reports Are Uniquely Valuable

01

Strategies Meet Execution

Platform data shows what actually happened — not just intentions or survey responses.

02

KPIs Against True Peers

Benchmarking against orgs on the same software eliminates apples-to-oranges comparisons.

03

Stories Await to Be Uncovered

Trends in your platform data reveal what's working before your competitors even notice.

2

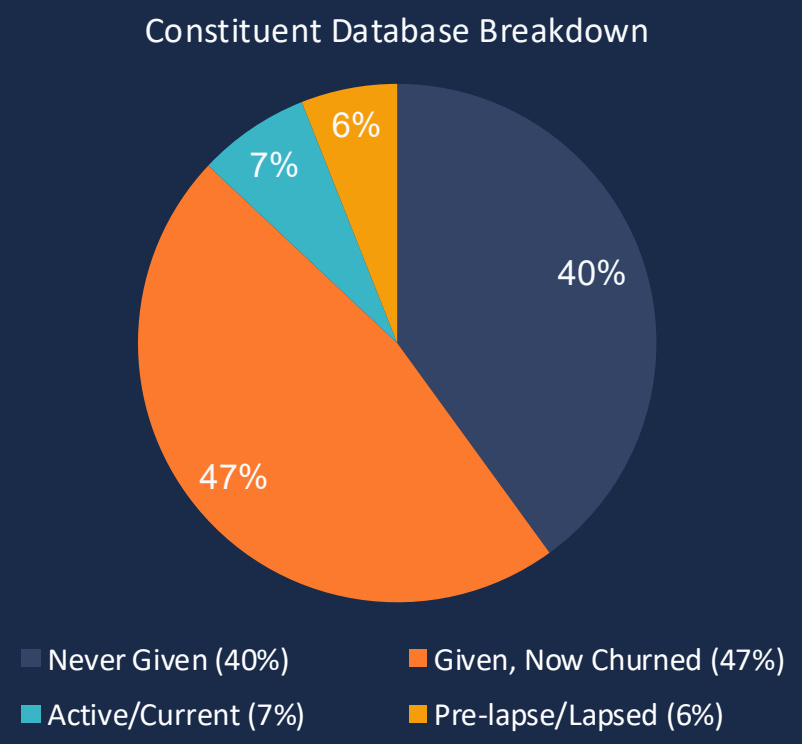
Benchmark Yourself

Your StratusLIVE software has a lot of the answers

2 CRM 365

CRM — What Does This Say About Data Efficiency?

30	11M	$176M	23
CRM Customers	Constituent Records	Total Giving in 2025	Active & Hosted Customers



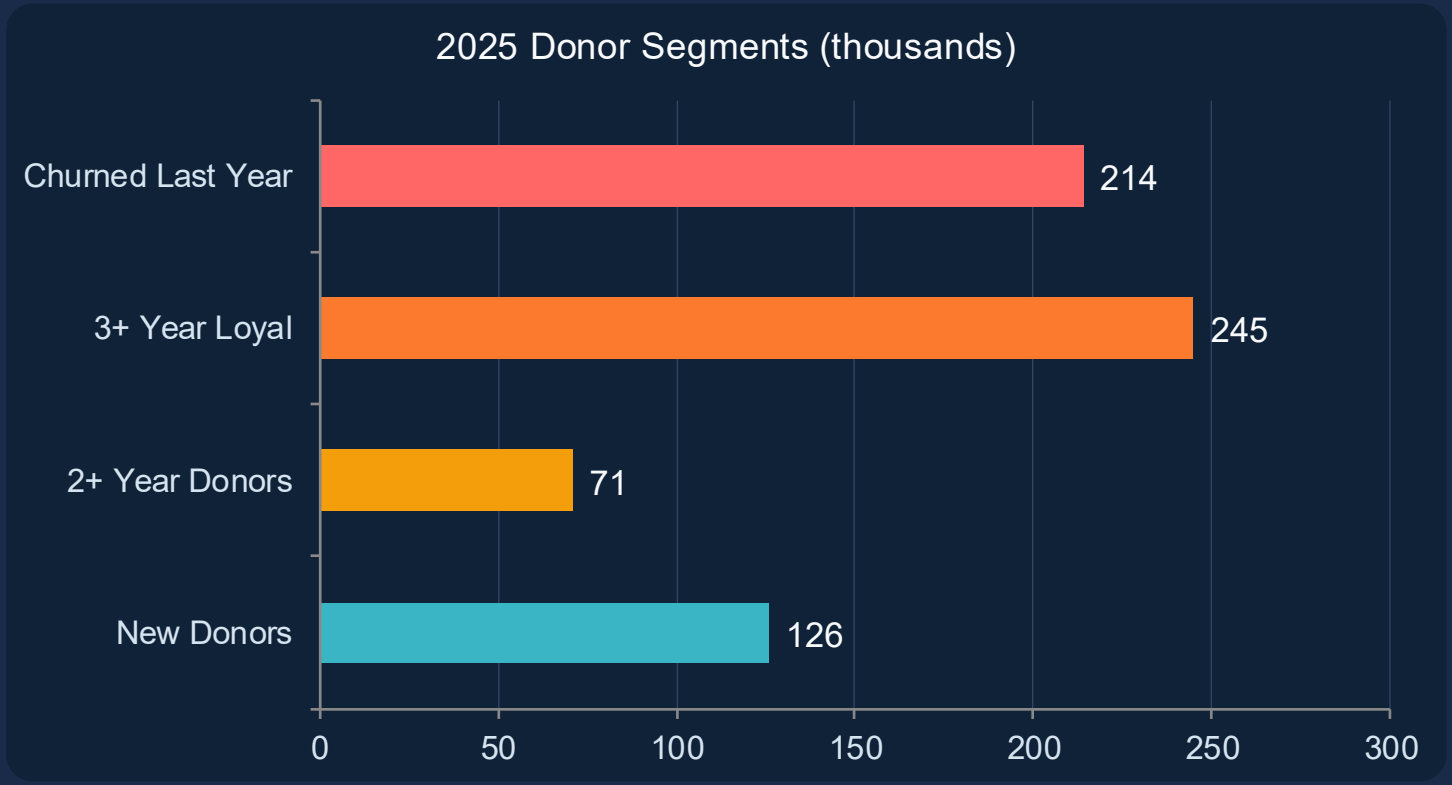
Key Observations

- 87% of all constituents meet the definition of churn (no gift in 36+ months)
- 60% of constituents have given at least once in 10 years
- 40% have NEVER given — every record still carries a cost
- Do you track data efficiency? Every record has a maintenance cost.

CRM — 2025 Donor Activity

We are engaging a small % of constituent records in any given year

$176M	463K	4%	126K
Total Giving 2025	Donors in 2025	of Total Records	New Donors (27%)



Observations

- Nonprofits must constantly rebuild their donor base
- Donor acquisition is not keeping pace with churn
- Only 7% of all historical donors gave in 2025
- 43% of 2025 donors gave 3+ times — protect this segment
- 214K donors churned last year — significant loss to recover

CRM — Loyalty & Churn Analysis 2025

Tracks against national averages

Lifecycle Stage	Donors	Median Gift	4-Year Churn	Key Action
First-Year	126K	$52	80%	Onboarding & second-gift ask are critical — most will never return
Second-Year	71K	$64	70%	Still high churn — the second gift is the most important ask
Multi-Year	67K	$100	54%	Improving loyalty — strong stewardship yields results
Loyal	129K	$127	40%	Best segment — prioritize for major gift cultivation and upgrades

CRM — Donor Database Health (Apr 2026)

Tracks against national averages

Segment	Donors	% of Base	Recommended Action
All Donors Who Have Ever Given	6,461K	100%	Baseline — your universe of giving relationships
Currently Churned (36+ months no gift)	5,632K	87%	Win-back campaigns, data hygiene, AI scoring urgently needed
Lapsed (26–36 months)	214K	3%	Reactivation outreach — still recoverable with the right ask
Pre-Lapse (14–25 months)	202K	3%	Retention urgency — immediate personalized engagement needed
Current or Reacquired	412K	7%	Steward, upgrade, and protect this segment at all costs

The Real Cost of Churn

Putting a dollar figure on your biggest retention problem

$13.7M

Annual revenue lost to churn
(214K donors × $64 median gift)

$21.4M

Acquisition cost to replace them
(214K × ~$100 avg cost/donor)

$12.9M

Pre-lapse revenue at risk
(202K donors at 14–25 months)

The Churn Math

- Replacing 214K churned donors costs more than the giving they generated
- 87% churn is higher than industry average
- Every year without a retention strategy compounds the deficit
- The 87% is not a fixed fact — it is a fixable problem

The Retention Opportunity

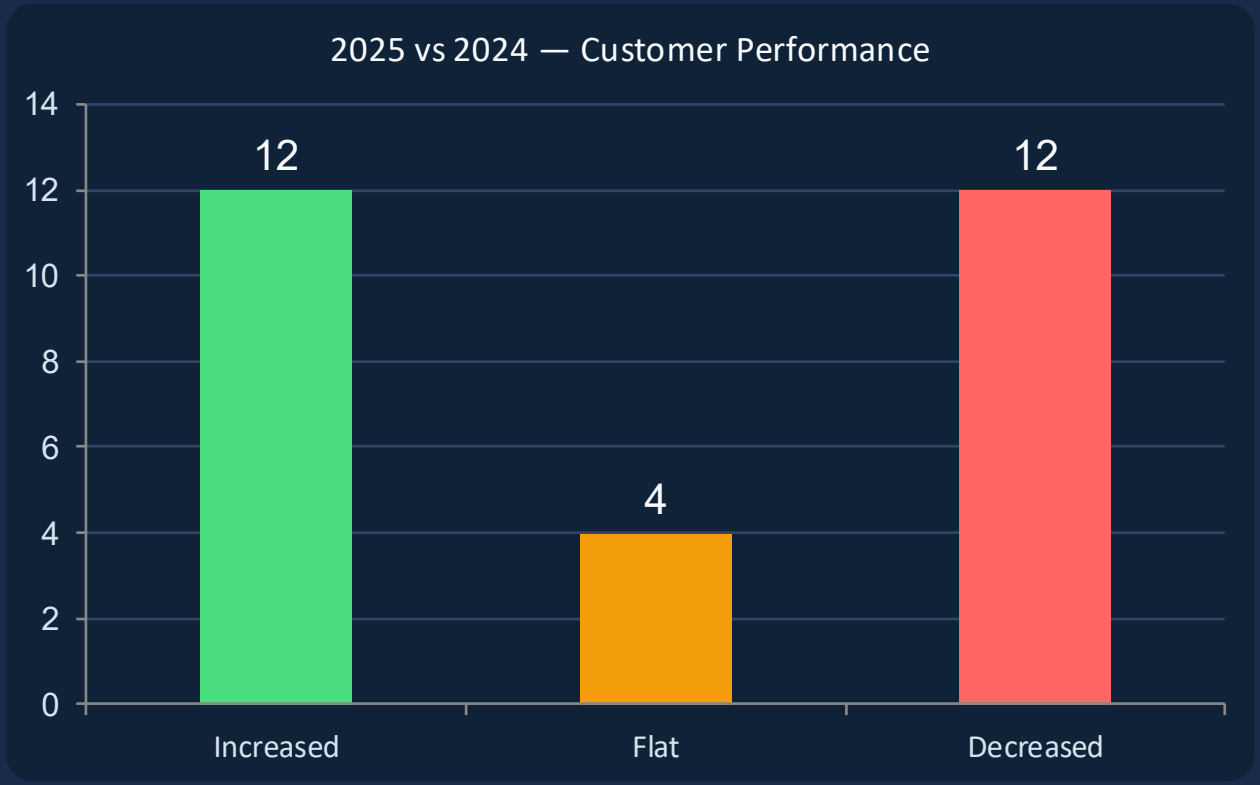
- A 10-point lift in first-year retention (20%→30%) retains ~12,600 additional donors
- Worth ~$800K in annual revenue — and it compounds every year they stay
- The pre-lapse segment (202K donors) is your most recoverable group — act before 36 months
- Lapsed + pre-lapse combined = 416K donors — nearly equal to your entire active base

Moving churn from abstract to budget-worthy: improving retention is cheaper than replacing donors.

2 Give at Work

Give at Work — Customer Overview

28	24	4	$98M
Total Customers	Federated Fundraisers	CSR Implementations	Raised in 2025



Notable YoY Increases

12 customers increased — top performers:

57%	18%
41%	15%
35%	10%
20%	

Give at Work — Campaigns & Sites

2M
Employees Across All Sites

38
Enterprise/National Accounts

1M
Employees in Enterprise Accounts

$65K
Revenue per Site (2025)

Metric	2024	2025	Change
Employers / Companies	677	776	+15%
Campaign Sites	1,711	1,501	-12%
Revenue per Site	$57K	$65K	+14%

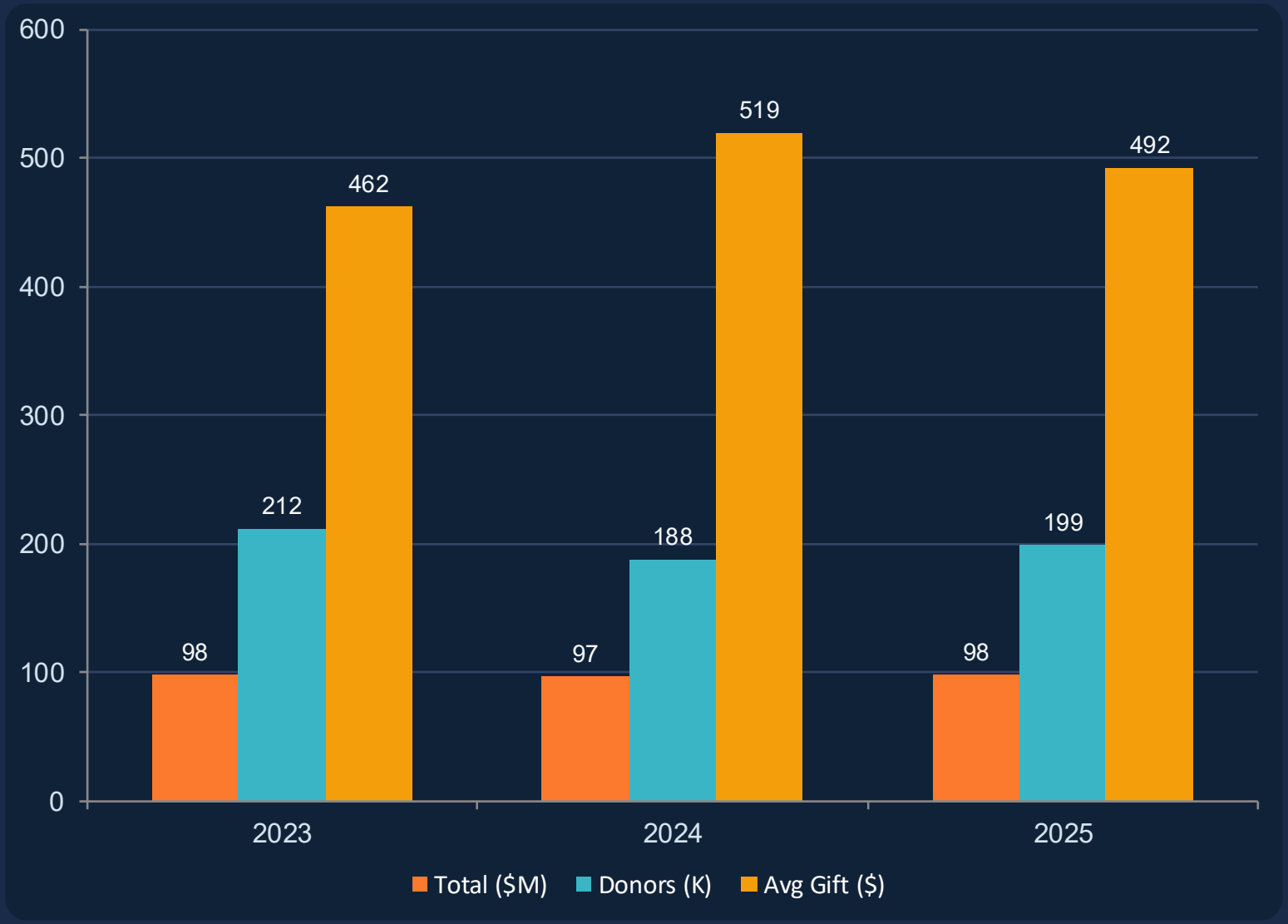
Key Insight

Fewer sites, higher revenue per site — quality over quantity is driving results.

Customers growing their site count are seeing proportional fundraising increases.

A smaller, well-activated site footprint outperforms a broad passive one.

Give at Work — 3-Year Giving Trends



Observations

- Total giving flat at ~$98M for 3 years — participation is the lever
- 10% participation rate in 2025 —below CECP averages
- $492 avg gift is close to the historic $500 payroll benchmark
- Donor count recovered +6% in 2025 after 2024 dip
- Opportunity: grow participation rate; the avg gift is already healthy

The Participation Rate Gap — A $49M Opportunity

Give at Work benchmark vs. CECP best-in-class

10%
SL GAW participation rate (2025)

15–25%
CECP best-in-class benchmark

$492
Average gift — already strong

The Gap — By the Numbers

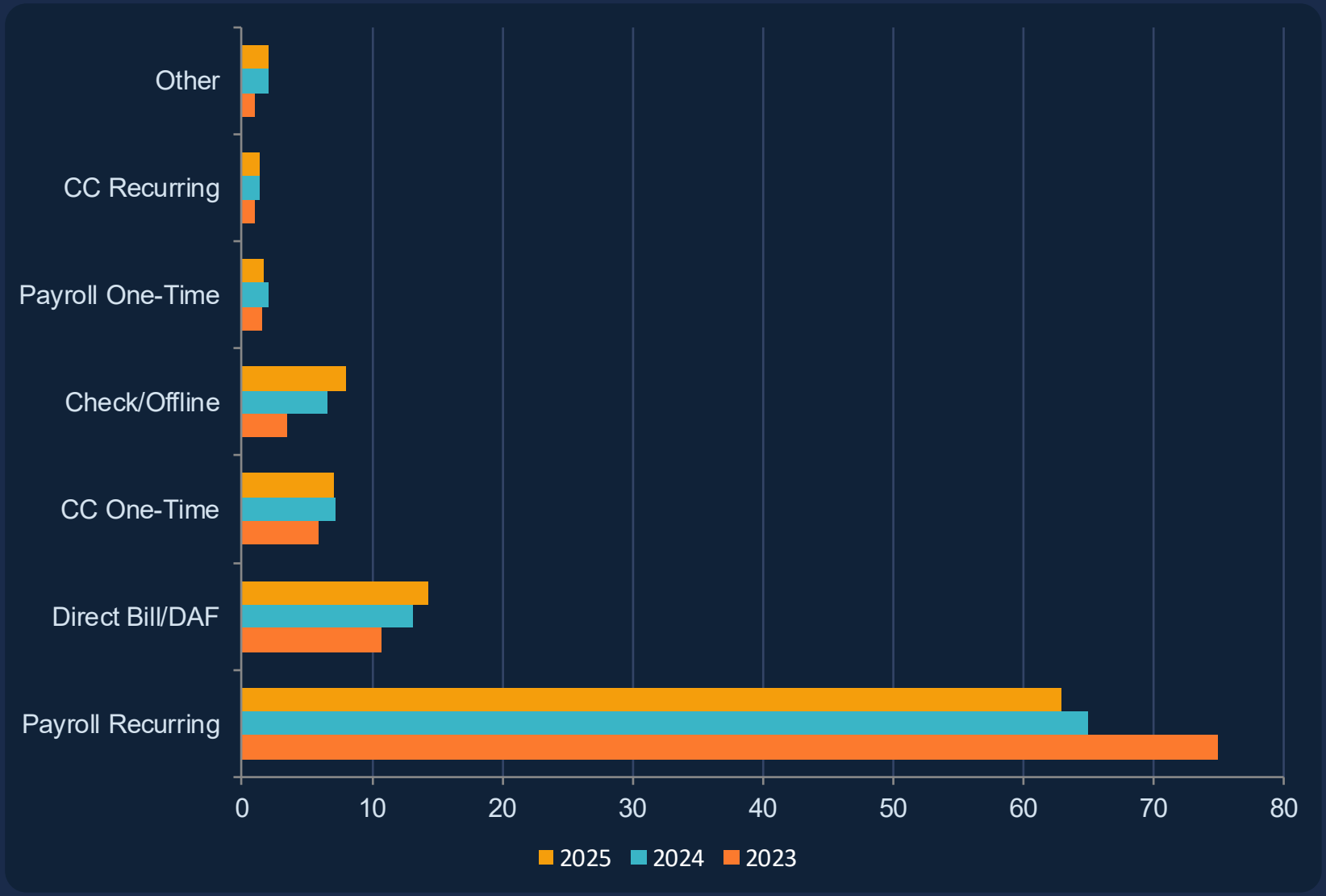
- 2M employees across all GAW sites in 2025
- At 10% participation = 200K donors (current)
- At 15% participation = 300K donors (+100K)
- +100K donors × $492 avg gift = $49M in incremental giving
- Even a 5-point lift — 10%→15% — would add ~$24.6M annually

What Drives Participation?

- Employer matching — the #1 driver of employee giving participation
- Campaign activation quality — engaged HR teams vs. passive deployments
- Cause diversity — giving to multiple causes increases participation by 30%+
- The avg gift is already $492 — the lever is participation, not gift size
- Customers growing their site count are seeing proportional fundraising increases

The average gift is already healthy at $492. Growing participation is the single highest-ROI action available.

Give at Work — Payment Method Trends ($M)



What's Shifting

- Payroll recurring: -16% over 3 years — a structural shift
- Direct Bill/DAF: +34% — avg gift $1,500+
- Check/offline: +129% surge — investigate why
- CC one-time holding steady
- With $250B in DAFs … focus on leadership giving

The DAF & Direct Bill Shift — A Structural Opportunity

The highest-value donors are migrating away from payroll

$63M vs. $14.3M

Payroll recurring shrinking vs. Direct Bill/DAF growing

$1,500+

Average DAF/Direct Bill gift vs. $492 payroll average

+34%

Direct Bill/DAF growth over 3 years (2023→2025)

The Payroll Decline

- Payroll recurring fell from $75M (2023) to $63M (2025) — a $12M decline in 3 years
- This is structural, not cyclical: younger employees prefer credit card, DAF, and direct options
- Organizations that depend on payroll as the only channel are exposed to continued erosion
- The era of payroll as the default giving channel is ending
- **SL is investigating ACH "pay-day giving"**

The DAF Opportunity

- DAFs now hold $250B+ in undeployed assets nationally — a massive reservoir of giving
- Is your org registered to receive DAF grants? Many are not.
- Shifting even 5% of payroll givers to DAF could add $5M+ at the higher avg gift
- Check/offline also surged +129% ($3.5M→$8M) — likely large donor behavior worth studying
- Enabling and promoting DAF options in campaigns is the single highest-value payment upgrade

Action: verify DAF registration and study the check/offline surge.

2 Ignite

Ignite — The Unified Platform

What It WAS Designed To Do

- Digital engagement platform
- Donation pages, events, volunteering
- Central constituent database
- Integrated with StratusLIVE CRM
- Reduce data management, increase data quality

→

What It IS Now

- Fundraising + workplace giving + events + volunteering — unified
- Built-in CRM capabilities
- AI-enabled insights and automation
- Shared volunteer, giving, and data networks across nonprofits
- Connects nonprofits through a unified ecosystem

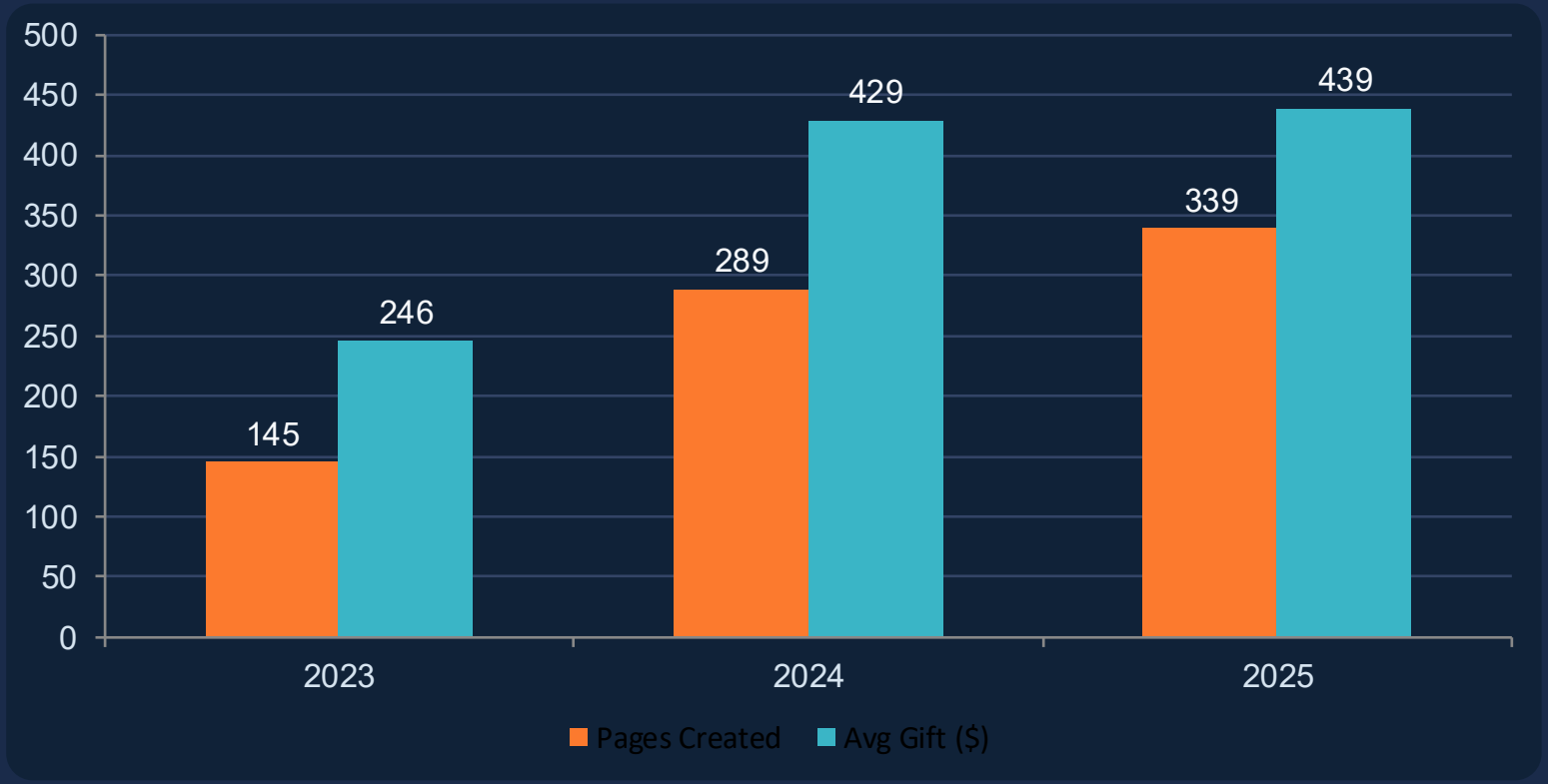
Ignite — Donation Pages

339
Pages Created (2025)

$4.4M
Revenue 2025

$439
Avg Gift 2025

$13K
Revenue per Page



Observations

- 2023 outlier: Hawaii wildfires drove $3.7M from just 145 pages
- $439 avg gift in 2025 far outpaces industry averages (~$150–200)
- Page creation +17% YoY — growing platform adoption
- Used for De Tocqueville, alumni, disaster response, event-giving pages

Ignite Donation Pages Outperform Industry by 2–3×

Strong competitive proof point

$439

StratusLIVE Ignite — avg online gift (2025)

$150–200

Industry average — online donation page gift

Why Ignite Outperforms

- Ignite pages skew toward leadership giving, alumni, and De Tocqueville — naturally higher gift levels
- Integrated CRM data enables personalized asks aligned to donor capacity
- Even accounting for use-case mix, performance is significantly above industry norms

Industry Comparison

- Neon One, Bloomerang, Salsa report avg online gifts of $110–175
- Network for Good / Classy report medians of $85–$150 for general campaigns
- At $439, Ignite pages perform at 2.5× the industry median — a compelling differentiator
- Page revenue per page ($13K) also significantly exceeds typical platform benchmarks of $5–8K

This is not just a data point — we need to study this further

Ignite — Events & Volunteering

224
Events Created (2025)

$487K
Event Revenue 2025

148
Volunteer Activities

1,336
Volunteers Tracked

	2023	2024	2025
Events Created	100	147	**224**
Event Revenue	$264K	$429K	**$487K**
Volunteer Activities	117	90	**148**
Volunteers Tracked	879	988	**1,336**

Data Gaps and Observations

- Not all events require registration — data is incomplete
- Not all events collect fees — revenue undercounts total value
- Volunteering created in CRM and GAW needs consolidation
- CVC is the superior volunteer management product — prioritize

2 Recurring gifts

The Recurring Giving Gap — Your Lowest-Hanging Fruit

The most impactful upgrade available to every organization in this room

20%

Current recurring giving rate (industry 2025)

80–90%

Recurring donor retention rate vs. 43% one-time

$10.2M

Potential annual revenue from 10% conversion to monthly

Why Recurring Changes Everything

- Recurring donors retain at 80–90% vs. 43% for one-time donors — a 2× retention advantage
- Recurring donors give 42% more per year than equivalent one-time donors (Blackbaud)
- Predictable monthly revenue enables better planning and reduces acquisition pressure
- Every recurring donor upgrade reduces your dependence on the constant acquisition treadmill

The Conversion Opportunity

- If just 10% of current one-time donors converted to recurring (~34,000 donors)
- At a typical recurring gift of $25/month = $300/year per donor
- That generates ~$10.2M in stable, high-retention annual revenue
- Ignite and CRM can automate recurring upgrade asks — this is a platform-native capability
- Start with your multi-year and loyal segments — highest conversion probability

Recurring giving is the single most powerful lever for improving retention, revenue stability, and lifetime value.

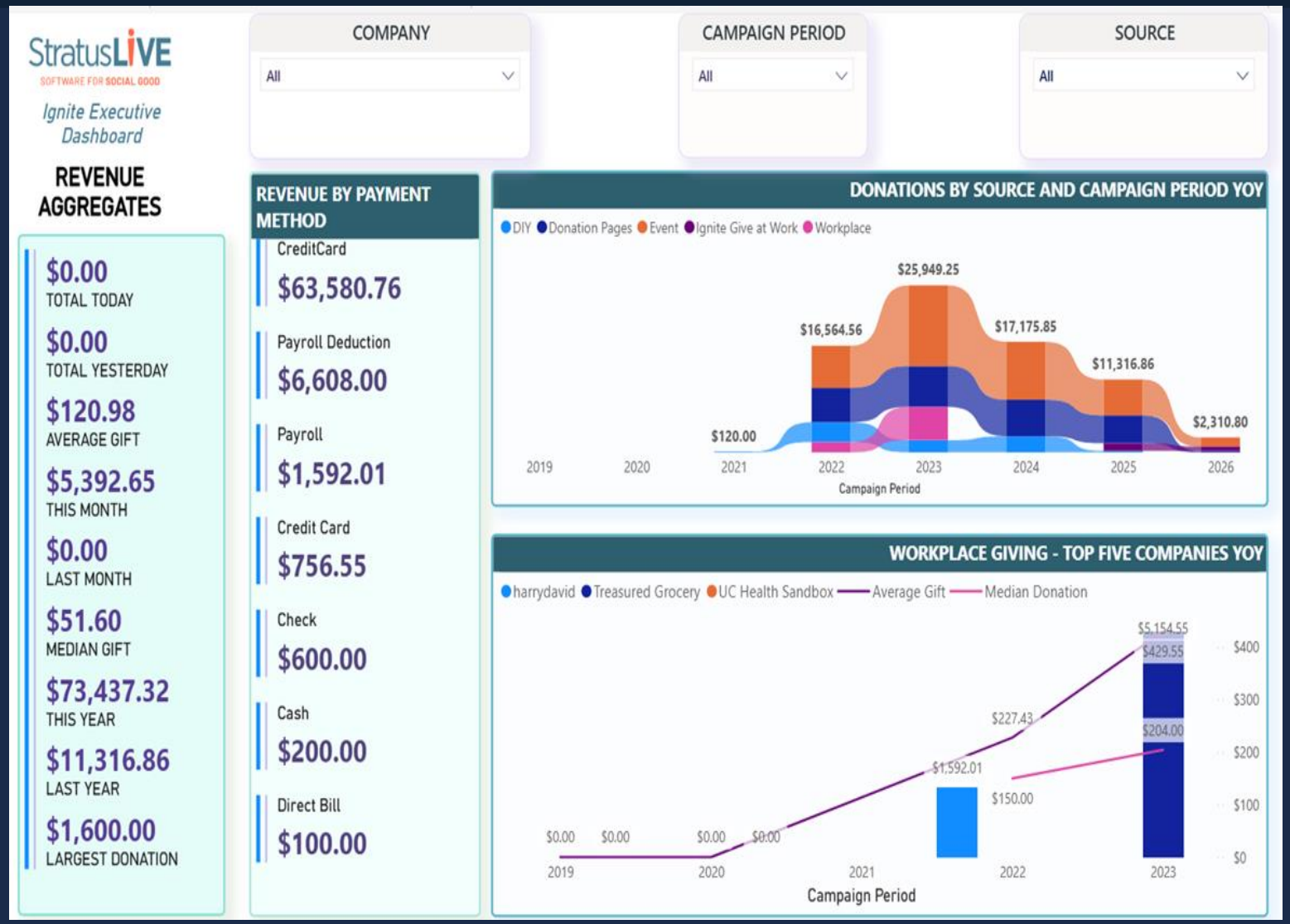
3

Where Do We Go From Here?

Takeaways, reporting tools, and how we can help

Need Help With Reporting?

Examples of StratusLIVE Power BI Dashboards



What This Dashboard Shows

- Revenue aggregates at a glance — today, YTD, last year
- Donations by source and campaign period, year over year
- Revenue breakdown by payment method
- Workplace giving — top companies, trend lines, averages
- Ignite Executive Dashboard: unified view across all channels
- Events, Fundraisers, and DIY pages in one place

Takeaways — How Can We Help?

01

Your KPIs Must Be Yours

Don't adopt industry benchmarks wholesale. Build your framework around your mission, goals, and leadership consensus.

02

Platform Data = Best Benchmarking

Vendor data benchmarks you against true peers on the same system — far more actionable than broad industry surveys.

03

Data Efficiency Is Real

Every constituent record has a cost. Audit your database, invest in active segments, and don't let the 87% drag you.

04

Go Deeper Than the Surface

StratusLIVE data trends with the market — the most valuable insights live in the segments you drill into.

05

The Future Is Unified & AI-Enabled

Ignite consolidates your data. AI is coming. Together they unlock insights that were simply impossible before.

Beyond Data: AI for Human Connection

SYNC

Thank You

stratuslive.com | info@stratuslive.com

StratusLIVE